The Noble Heart of the Ten Vajrapāṇis

Āryadaśavajrapāṇihṛdaya · Toh 951 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྡོ་རྗེབཅུའི་སྙིང་པོ།

The Heart of the Ten Noble Vajrapāṇis, known in Sanskrit as the Āryadaśavajrapāṇihṛdaya and in Tibetan as Phakpa Lakna Dorjé Chuyi Nyingpo, is a short protective scripture spoken by the Buddha. It is set in the Jeta Grove at Śrāvastī, where the Blessed One tells the venerable Ānanda that anyone who knows the names, the clans, or the secret mantra of the ten great yakṣa generals called the Vajrapāṇis cannot be overcome by sorcery. Such a person will be safe from harm by yakṣas, rākṣasas, and other malevolent spirits, including those that strike from behind. The text then presents the mantra itself, making it a dhāraṇī whose recitation is meant to bring protection. It is Toh 951 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: āryadaśavajrapāṇihṛdaya
In the language of Tibet: The Heart of the Ten Noble Vajrapāṇis.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, any son or daughter of good family who knows the names of the ten great yakṣa generals, the Vajrapāṇis, or knows their clans, or knows their secret mantra, cannot be overcome by sorcery. Yakṣas will not harm them. Rākṣasas, eaters of leftovers, and eaters of incense will not harm them. Even those that strike from behind will not harm them.

tadyathā u ki ri ma ki ri mi rī ca parṇa śa va ri u li me mi li me i li me mi li me i li me mi li me i li ma li me hig ke dhig ke hug ke dhu dhu re pra dha re a laṃ pha le phā laṃ pha le khu khu me ti ku me tu me khi ri khi ri sva dha sā dha sarva bag kva le ban dha ma bag kva le

Ānanda, to these ten great yakṣa generals, the Vajrapāṇis, say this: By the command of the Blessed One, receive this entreaty: always follow close behind me, and even when I am asleep, intoxicated, or utterly intoxicated, guard me, protect me, hold me, look after me, and bring me peace and well-being!

They are Victorious Bull, Āṭavaka, Haimavata, Pāñcika, Maṇibhadra, Excellent Fame, Kubera's son, Adorner, Lovely Garland, and the great king, protector of the Dharma, Vaiśravaṇa. To these ten great yakṣa generals, the Vajrapāṇis, say this: By the command of the Blessed One, receive this entreaty: always follow close behind me, and even when I lie asleep, am intoxicated, or utterly intoxicated, guard me, protect me, hold me, look after me, and bring me peace and well-being!

May these bases of secret mantra be accomplished! svāhā

tadyathā sa ra sa ra ṇe svāhā

The bases of the secret mantras of those ten Vajrapāṇis are these:

tadyathā u ge te ke te saṃ ka te uddu le dha dhe ta te ta patte svāhā ci ce ci ce ci khe lo cched ne bhed ni sarva birya che da ni sarva kra ta kā khorda pa ra kṛ tanā śa ni

The supreme bases of the secret mantras of those ten great kings of vidyā-mantra, the Vajrapāṇis, are these:

tadyathā a le lakṣe ba ke le la kṣe a ke pa ke yakṣe svāhā

tadyathā hu tu hu tu hu tu tu bi tu bi tu bi tu tu gaccha sab te pa ta ha ta ye svāhā

na mo bha ga bā te buddha sya siddhya na tu mantra pa dā svāhā"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes The Heart of the Ten Noble Vajrapāṇis.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The class of beings rendered "those that strike from behind" is uncertain. The Tibetan literally means "those who place afterward."

In the first entreaty the text reads "sleep-hand," which makes no sense and is probably a scribal error for "lie." The parallel second entreaty has "lie asleep," and that reading is followed here.

The words "say this" before each entreaty are not in the Tibetan. They are supplied to make clear that the entreaty that follows is addressed to the yakṣa generals in the first person.

Several of the ten names could not be identified with confidence, so their meanings are translated: Victorious Bull, perhaps Jinarṣabha; Excellent Fame, perhaps Yaśobhadra; Adorner; and Lovely Garland. The phrase "Kubera's son" stands in the Tibetan with an instrumental particle before "Adorner." It is taken here as two separate names so that the list numbers ten, but it may instead be one name, "Adorner, son of Kubera."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.